

LEVEL DESIGN DOCUMENT:

BIRTH OF MIRACLE

STEP 1: THE IDEA

Birth of Miracle is an adventure game featuring puzzle-platform and light RPG elements, based on the curiosity and observations of a Wanderer (Player) who has no memory of their past, set in a utopian world (Sanctara) that gives a sense of "uncanny perfection" where there is no concept of time or night. A playable level design will be prepared for this project.

STEP 2: SETTINGS, LOCATION AND THEME

Environmental Setting: Sanctara/Eden Era (Pre-Destruction). Symmetrical, flawless, and infinitely radiant.

Key Locations:

- Forest (Arfashilis): Starting point.
- Valley (Arfashilas): Open area containing the River and the Pit.
- Garden (Arfashivis): The outskirts of the Castle.
- Castle (Sanctarium): The final destination.

Theme: "The Birth of Curiosity" and "Uncanny Perfection".

STEP 3: PROJECT GOAL

Goal: To make the player feel the uncanniness created by "everything being too perfect" in a pre-chaos utopia, and to bring a project I have been working on paper for a long time to life at a baseline level. Project Goal Statement: To complete a 10–15-minute exploration prototype where the player deepens the story through their own choices without using violence (relying solely on stealth and puzzles).

STEP 4: FEATURES

Unique Features:

1. Non-Violent Interaction: Calming enemies by feeding them instead of killing them.
2. Notebook System: Deepening the story by completing unfinished texts.

Feature List: (These features are not fully integrated mechanics in the prototype).

1. Puzzle mechanics
2. Platforming sections
3. Follow AI
4. Stealth mechanics
5. Environmental interactions

STEP 5: STORY

What?: The game takes place in a dimension called "Sanctara" (Eden), where there is no concept of time, the sun never sets, and biological needs (hunger, thirst, sleep) do not exist. This is an uncannily perfect utopia, decorated with symmetrical rivers and golden-leaved flora, with "Sanctarium", God's personal castle, at its center. Our character, the "Wanderer", has fallen into this world through a white portal of light from an unknown universe. Although they have no physical needs, they have pitched a tent in the forest and built a campsite to maintain their mental integrity and avoid going mad. They spend their days mapping this strange world and noting down plants and creatures they have never seen before. They are completely alone in this world.

How?: The story, which begins on an ordinary (and endless) day for the Wanderer, turns into a journey triggered by the element of "Curiosity":

- Routine and Observation (Beginning - Forest): The Wanderer wakes up in their tent. Although they never get hungry, out of habit, they gather delicious fruits from the surroundings. As they progress through the forest ("Arfashilis"), they note the stillness and silence of nature in their notebook.
- Bonding (Middle - Fox): Deep in the forest, they encounter the giant "Fox" (Erthelian), the land guardian of Sanctara. This creature is not normally aggressive but protects its territory. Instead of fighting it, the Wanderer offers it the "Golden Apples" they have gathered. This action transforms a wild creature into a loyal companion.

- The Turning Point (Climax - Valley): Descending into the valley (Arfashilas), the Wanderer discovers a massive pit (Orthodionois) filled with strange symbols carved into the ground. The Wanderer hides among the "Bushes" and observes the situation. From the light emerges an "Angel" (Orthodionos) with six wings and skin gliding like silk. Before ascending to the sky, the Angel drops a piece of paper bearing the exact same symbols found in the pit. The Wanderer must retrieve the note without being seen by the angels patrolling the area and continue their progression.
- Action and Finale (Resolution - Castle): On the way to the castle, they cross the fiercely flowing river by riding on the back of their befriended Fox, but they must part ways with it to climb the mountain upon which the castle stands. Upon reaching the gigantic gothic gate of the castle, they solve the puzzle on the gate using the runes from the note they hold, taking their first step into the library inside—the room where all the knowledge of the universe is hidden.

Why?: The Wanderer's presence in this world is like a "glitch." They neither belong there nor can they escape it. The Wanderer knows that the center of their maps always remains blank. Discovering what lies inside the "Castle" (Sanctarium) they see on the horizon is the only thing that excites them in this endless and cyclical existence. Search for Meaning: The paper dropped by the angel is proof that this world is "artificial" and controlled by a "creator." The Wanderer must enter that castle to uncover God's secret.

Show, Don't Tell: The perfection of the world gives the player a sense of "uncanniness" rather than peace. No leaf fades, no fruit rots. This is supported by the monologues the player writes in their notebook (UI). The fact that the player "hides" when seeing an Angel or another creature instead of attacking it communicates how mighty and terrifying these beings are without using dialogue. Similarly, feeding a giant Fox with an apple demonstrates that this world is not built on "violence." The background is consistently bright and radiant. The absence of night visually constantly reminds the player of the feeling that time does not pass.

STEP 7: GOALS, OBSTACLES, AND SET PIECES

1. Goal: Exit the forest.
 - Obstacle: The Fox is blocking the path.
 - Solution: Evade the Fox's attacks, collect "Apples," and feed the Fox.
2. Goal: Cross the valley.
 - Obstacle: Angels (Orthodionos) are patrolling.

- Solution: Sneak past by hiding behind the fox, which is now with us, and utilizing environmental elements if necessary.
- 3. Goal: Cross the river.
 - Obstacle: The "Water" current is very strong.
 - Solution: Cross to the other side by riding on the Fox's back and managing the stamina bar.
- 4. Goal: The Finale
 - Obstacle: The castle gate is closed.
 - Solution: To open the gate, the rocks in front of it must be clicked in sequence.

STEP 8: FOCAL POINT

In Birth of Miracle, since the environment changes in parallel with the player's journey, there are multiple focal points. Rather than a single massive landscape, it is designed as three interconnected atmospheric zones. Each zone has its own dominant focal point that draws and guides the player.

Zone 1: THE FOREST (Arfashilis)

The aesthetic of this region is in organic, warm, and golden-yellow tones shaped by dense trees and thick vegetation. Because the line of sight is restricted, the player cannot see the distant castle here; instead, intense Golden Light Shafts filtering through the trees and worn paths on the ground are the main elements guiding the player. This represents the beginning of the story and the Wanderer's routine. As the player progresses following the clearings where the light concentrates, they feel lost within the peaceful yet labyrinthine structure of the environment. In the player's mind, this place will be remembered as the realm of "natural beauty" and the bond formed with the Fox. The end of the zone offers a natural transition as the trees thin out.

Zone 2: The Valley (Arfashilas)

The wide and flat terrain that greets the player upon exiting the forest creates a sense of relief, contrasting with the claustrophobia of the previous zone. The undisputed focal point of this region is the massive Pit (Orthodionois), which diverges from the natural texture with geometric symbols carved into the ground, and the Angels ascending to the sky from within it. This "artificial" and uncanny structure visualizes the breaking point of the story. Players find their bearings in this open area thanks to the fierce River that cuts across the region. The flow direction and sound of the river act as a natural compass guiding the player to where they need to go (the opposite shore). The player will

remember this zone by the angel descending from the sky and that massive, mysterious rift in the ground.

Zone 3: Garden & Castle (Arfashivis & Sanctarium)

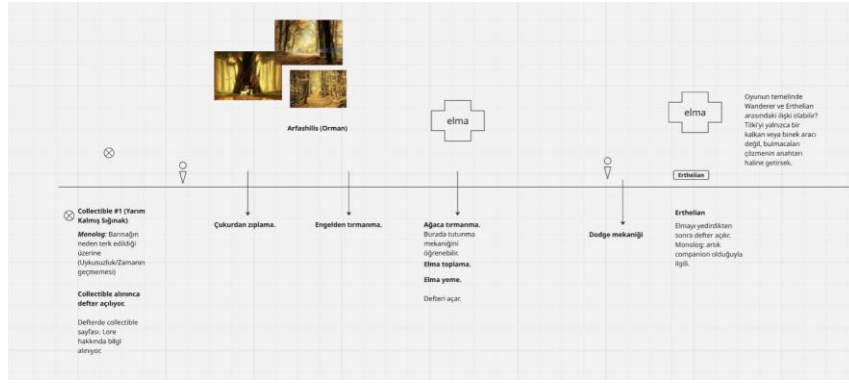
After crossing the river with the help of the Fox, the color palette shifts from warm gold to a cold, sacred white. The focal point of this final zone is the Sanctarium Castle and its Gothic architecture, completely dominating the horizon. The ground continuously slopes upwards; this Vertical structure ensures the player's gaze is constantly directed upward. This is the resolution point of the story. With its flawless symmetry and colossal size, the Castle evokes a sense of "insignificance" and "awe" in the player. The player enters this magnificent structure by climbing the walls and solving the puzzle at the gate. The final lingering image will be that gigantic gate where nature ends and the "Creator's" artificial perfection begins.

STEP 9: TOP-DOWN LAYOUT (LEVEL LAYOUT)

The level is divided into 4 main sections that progress from left to right but also include vertical gameplay areas.

ZONE 1: THE FOREST (ARFASHILIS) This region is where the basic movement mechanics are taught and the story begins.

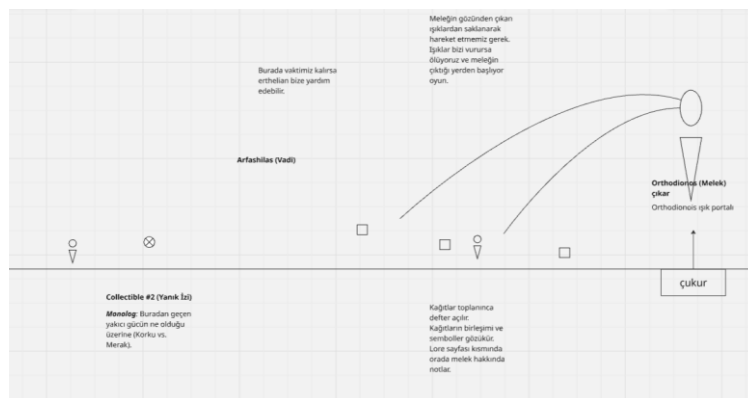
- **Start and Exploration:** The player begins the level on the far left. The first interaction point is the Wanderer's tent. When this object is picked up, the notebook opens and a monologue about "Insomnia/The absence of passing time" is triggered.
- **Movement Tutorial:** As the player progresses, they overcome the following obstacles in order:
 - **Jumping over a Pit:** Basic jump mechanic.
 - **Climbing over an Obstacle:** Climbing onto a high rock. Here, the player is taught the "Grab Mechanic".
- **Boss/Companion Encounter (Erthelian):** At the end of the zone, the giant Fox (Erthelian) blocks the path.
 - **Combat:** First, the player is taught the dodge mechanic.
 - **Solution:** The player feeds the apple to the Fox. After this action, the Fox does not become a mount/shield vehicle, but a key/companion that solves puzzles and starts following the player.



ZONE 2: THE VALLEY (ARFASHILAS)

Exiting the forest leads to a wide, open valley. This area focuses on Stealth rather than action.

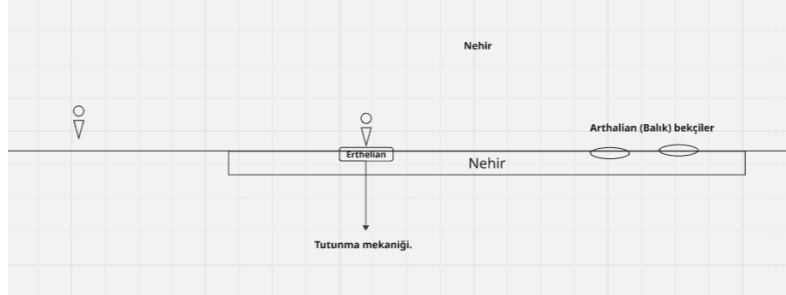
- Main Event: Angels (Orthodionos) ascend above the Pit ahead.
- Stealth Sequence: The Angel hovers in the air and sweeps the ground with light beams shooting from its eyes.
 - Mechanic: If the lights touch the player, the player dies and the sequence restarts.
 - Goal: To progress by hiding from the lights behind the Fox's walk and to collect the piece of paper dropped by the Angel.
- Reward: Once the papers are collected, the notebook opens; the joined symbols reveal the "Lore" information and notes about the Angel.



ZONE 3: THE RIVER

It is the large body of water that separates the Valley from the garden where the Castle is located.

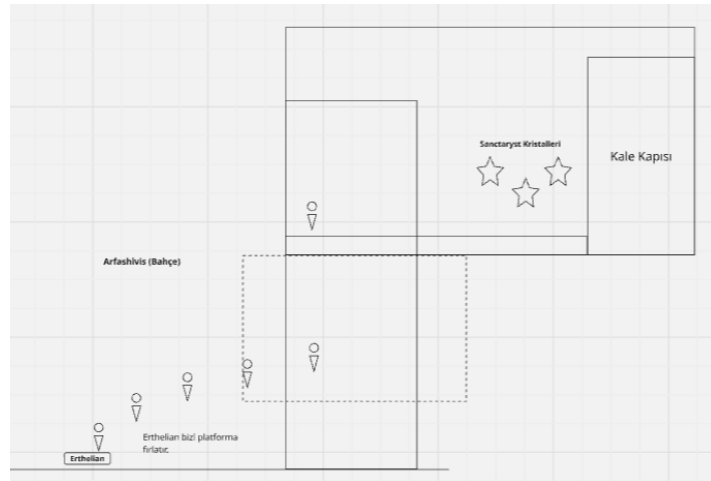
- Obstacle: A wide and impassable River.
- Solution (Mount Mechanic): The player rides on Erthelian's (Fox's) back.
 - Mechanic: The "Grab Mechanic" is critical here. The player must constantly hold on to avoid falling.



ZONE 4: GARDEN & CASTLE (ARFASHIVIS & SANCTARIUM)

After crossing the river, the game shifts to a Vertical Gameplay structure.

- Ascent: The castle is on a high platform. Erthelian throws the player onto the first platform above.
- Platforming: After being thrown by Erthelian, the player progresses by climbing upwards on walls or ledges.
- Puzzle: Upon reaching the very top, in front of the Castle Gate, the player encounters the "Sanctaryst Crystals".
- Finale: The crystals are interacted with according to the symbols on the papers collected in the valley section, the gate opens, and the level ends.



STEP 10: VISUAL DEVELOPMENT

The visual identity of the project was shaped by analyzing style references gathered from online resources and combining them with original in-game assets created accordingly. The chosen art style adopted a Stylized 3D and Low Poly aesthetic, intentionally moving away from realism to create a fairy-tale and mystical atmosphere. Characters and environmental elements feature soft, hand-painted textures similar to games like *The Legend of Zelda: Breath of the Wild* or *Horizon Zero Dawn*, while the geometry was deliberately left angular to emphasize a digital and artificial sense of "perfection." The most important feature that makes this project visually unique is the choice of assets that step outside conventional fantasy designs. Instead of angels in standard human form, geometric and surreal "Biblically Accurate Angel" designs were used, adding a cosmic uncanniness to the world. Additionally, the low-poly structure of trees and rocks in nature depictions was not hidden but highlighted as a stylistic choice; with spherical tree leaves and sharp-edged rocks, the fact that the game is a "designed utopia" was visually conveyed. The color palette of the game consists predominantly of warm tones to support the "Endless Day" theme. The dominant color is golden yellow and amber tones, manifesting on the forest floor, trees, the Fox character, and collectible objects. This warm dominance is balanced with secondary colors such as sacred White/cream and cosmic purple/blue tones in the sky, preventing the scene from looking monotonous. The lighting setup is structured so that shadows are soft and minimal, with every point of the scene illuminated equally with divine brightness; while the primary light source is a warm sun yellow, shadows are in slightly cold gray/blue tones to create contrast.

STEP 11: LISTS (ASSET LIST)

Characters

1. Player: Main character (Wanderer)
2. Fox: Boss and companion character (Erthelian)
3. Angel: Blocking enemy/NPC (Orthodionos)

Environment and Nature

1. Tree: Main models forming the forest structure
2. Brushwood: Vegetation, grass, bushes
3. Flower: Ground detailing
4. Mushroom: Decorative elements within the forest
5. Rock: Obstacle and platform structures
6. Water: River material/shader and effects

7. Pit: The area where the angel is encountered
8. Background: 2D background

Structures and Objects

1. Castle: The magnificent structure at the finale (Sanctarium)
2. Tent: "Shelter" area object for storytelling
3. Campfire: The fire next to the tent
4. Apple: Collectible object to feed the fox and unlock story elements